

Watertown Student Finds Success From YouTube Channel, Millions of Viewers

BY MATTOX WARD

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Watertown, New York — A Watertown High School student is becoming a viral sensation in online gaming, with their latest video reaching 1 million views on YouTube.

Mattox Ward, 17, a senior at Watertown High, launched his YouTube channel in 2017 under the alias MathGenius. Here, he began creating documentary-style videos surrounding the game Geometry Dash.

Seven years later, Ward has reached nearly 40,000 subscribers and gained almost 5 million views, numbers that he never expected to achieve when starting his channel.

“Originally, this channel was meant to be a time capsule of all the interesting things I would make,” Ward said. “Whether that be racing marbles down a track, creating obstacle courses with LEGOs or playing my favorite video games, I saw YouTube as a way to sort of document myself over the years.”

Ward’s inspiration to begin his channel was also spurred by his mother, Pamela Barrett, who noticed his passion for media very early on.

“Since he was a kid, he’s always been obsessed with technology and being in front of the camera,” Barrett said. “So when he found people on YouTube making videos about the things he was interested in, he immediately wanted to do the same.”

Ward started his breakthrough YouTube project in April 2022, with the goal of documenting the eight year journey to complete Geometry Dash’s hardest level. After hundreds of hours of research, interviews, scriptwriting and editing, he released his “35-minute magnum opus essay” on Aug. 3.

The video has amassed 1.03 million views and 18,000 likes, and he states that this marks the beginning of what he hopes will be his future career.

“It makes me so happy to see the content that I put my heart and soul into, resonate with so many people,” Ward said. “I am so blessed to be able to do what I love every single day, and I wouldn’t trade it for anything else.”

After graduation, Ward plans to attend Quinnipiac University to begin working toward a master’s degree in Interactive Media and Communications, and he has no plans of stopping the YouTube channel any time soon.

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